

Of splits and partitions

The new improved features in this version are its password support, conversion of FAT32 file system to NTFS, support for Win Me and Win 2000 professional, and a wizard for copy partition and undelete partition, which make it more user friendly and a complete utility in itself. Partition-Info gives you information about the partitions on your hard disk.

Partition Magic 6.0



SPECIFICATIONS:

Features: Multiple operating system management; support for FAT, FAT32, Linux Ext2, Linux SWAP, NTFS, and HPFS partitions

verdict

A -

Partition Magic 6.0

Ease of use	▲▲▲▲▲
Features	▲▲▲▲▲
Performance	▲▲▲▲▲
Value for Money	▲▲▲▲▲
OVERALL	▲▲▲▲▲

+ Intuitive interface
+ Easy to use
+ Feature rich
Price: Rs 3,150
Contact: G.T. Enterprise
Phone: 080-6606093 **Fax:** 080-6671407
E-mail: gtdrom@vsnl.com
Web site: www.gtdrom.com

Poor show

This anti-virus program proved to be below par in detecting old and new viruses. It failed to detect any of the 9000 viruses we used for testing in the compressed form. The software succeeded in detecting and repairing the viruses only after they were extracted into a temp folder. Protector Plus also lacks features such as scanning your e-mail for virus.

Protector Plus 2000



SPECIFICATIONS:

Features: DOS boot up check, browsing virus scan, download scan, script blocking, can create reports and download updates

Benchmarks:

No viruses detected in compressed form
To test detection capabilities in the uncompressed form, we unzipped some of the newer and deadlier viruses and it detected all of them

verdict

B

Protector Plus 2000

Ease of use	▲▲▲▲▲
Features	▲▲▲▲▲
Performance	▲▲▲▲▲
Value for Money	▲▲▲▲▲
OVERALL	▲▲▲▲▲

+ Easy installation, simple to use
+ Virus updates from the Net
- No viruses detected in compressed form, no e-mail scanning
Price: Rs 1,950 **Contact:** Adit Microsys
Phone: 079-6400255
E-mail: sales@aditmicosys.com
Web site: www.aditmicosys.com

Ghost of an image

This version is more advanced and can perform more jobs. The new features include auto backup of the client machine; the ability to load the disk image with different hardware configurations; the ability to customise the client computer to individual or group needs by cloning the image of one computer on all the other machines over the network.

Symantec Ghost 7.0



SPECIFICATIONS:

Features: Images can be dumped onto a client machine through the network, lets you dump image on the PC with different hardware configurations, simplified backup and recovery

verdict

B +

Symantec Ghost 7.0

Ease of use	▲▲▲▲▲
Features	▲▲▲▲▲
Performance	▲▲▲▲▲
Value for Money	▲▲▲▲▲
OVERALL	▲▲▲▲▲

+ Feature rich
+ Very detailed manual
- Bit difficult for first timer
Price: Dependent on number of users
Contact: Tech Pacific
Phone: 022-5960227
E-mail: vpai@symantec.com

Video editor

This video editing software comes along with a PCI capture card. It lets you capture VHS from camcorders or any other recording device to your PC through the PCI capture card. It lets you capture full length, full motion videos on your PC. The installation is simple and takes around 104 MB of disk space with additional tools for non-linear editing.

Studio DC Plus 10



SPECIFICATIONS:

104 MB free hard disk space; compression ratio: user selectable from 3:1:1 to 100:1; maximum resolution of 640x480, 30 frames/60 fields per second; 640x480, 30 frames/60 fields per second output

Features: Additional tools for non-linear editing (Micro Video Expert, Studio DC10 Hardware Test, Vidcap, DirectX diagnostic tools), facility to insert sound files and titles

verdict

B +

Studio DC Plus 10

Ease of use	▲▲▲▲▲
Features	▲▲▲▲▲
Performance	▲▲▲▲▲
Value for Money	▲▲▲▲▲
OVERALL	▲▲▲▲▲

+ Compact, easy to use, cheap
- Fewer features
Price: Rs11,899
Contact: Pinnacle Systems
Phone: 011-6464505
Fax: 011-6231431
E-mail: ksanghi@pinnaclesys.com